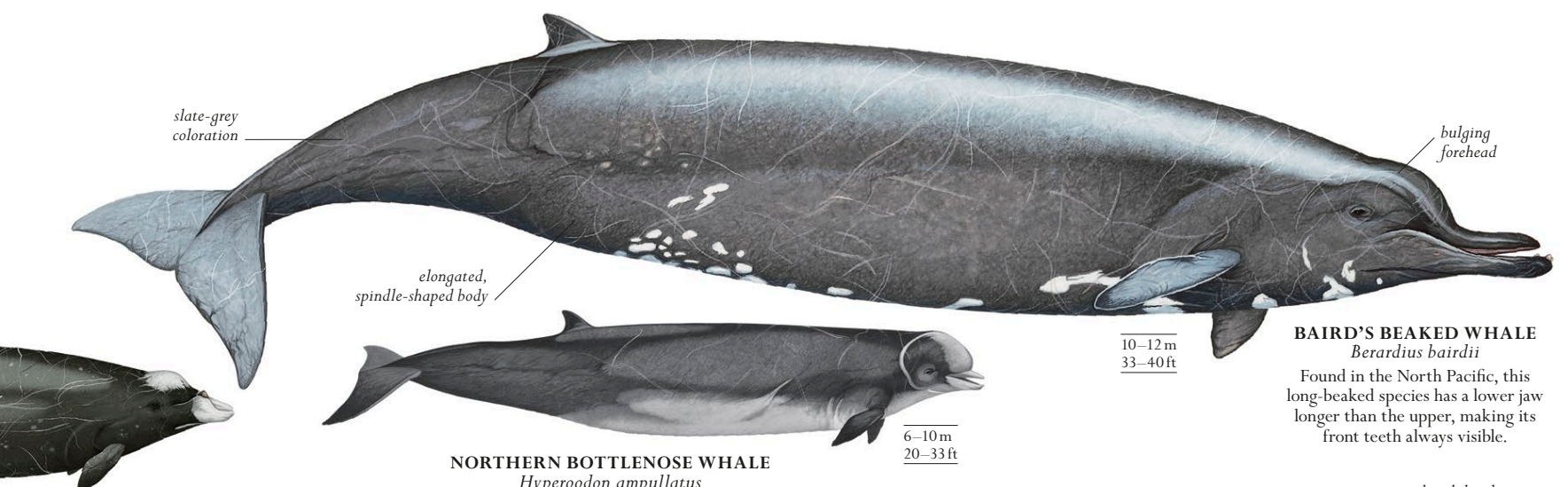




BAIRD'S BEAKED WHALE

Berardius bairdii

Found in the North Pacific, this long-beaked species has a lower jaw longer than the upper, making its front teeth always visible.

NORTHERN BOTTLENOSE WHALE

Hyperoodon ampullatus

With a swollen forehead and small, curved fin, this northern Atlantic species has a long beak – white in males and grey in females.

SHEPHERD'S BEAKED WHALE

Tasmacetus shepherdii

Known mainly from strandings in Australasia and S. America, this species has a diffused creamy body pattern and numerous small teeth.

CUVIER'S BEAKED WHALE

Ziphius cavirostris

Found worldwide, this whale has a shorter beak than others in the family. It is variable in colour, with a whitish head and back.



PYGMY AND DWARF SPERM WHALES

The Kogiidae are small whales with a strongly recurved dorsal fin. They have a characteristic pale, crescent-shaped marking behind each eye that looks rather like the gill opening of a shark.



PYGMY SPERM WHALE

Kogia breviceps

One of the smallest whales, this species is an inhabitant of deep temperate and tropical waters. It is known mainly from strandings.

2.7–4.2 m
8¾–13¾ ft

NARWHAL AND BELUGA

The Monodontidae form a small family of two medium-sized Arctic whales that are rather unusual in appearance. They are highly gregarious species and are found in bays, estuaries, and fjords, and along the edges of pack ice, sometimes in herds of several hundred. Neither species has a true dorsal fin; both have a swollen, rounded forehead, which can change shape when they produce sounds, of which they have a wide range.

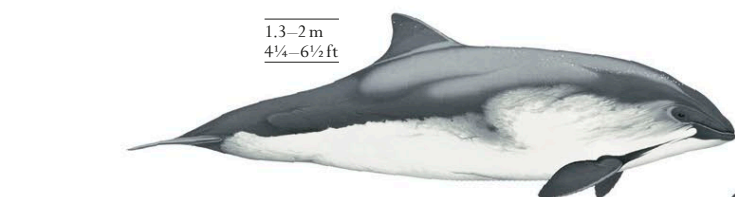


NARWHAL

Monodon monoceros

Mottled grey and brown in colour, the narwhal has only two teeth, one of which grows into a twisted tusk up to 3 m (10 ft) long in adult males.

body scarred by polar bear



HARBOUR PORPOISE

Phocoena phocoena

Widespread across the northern hemisphere, the harbour porpoise is one of the most familiar cetaceans. Often found in estuaries, it sometimes ventures upriver.



BURMEISTER'S PORPOISE

Phocoena spinipinnis

This dark porpoise, with a distinctive backward-pointing dorsal fin, is one of the most abundant cetaceans around the coasts of S. America.



VAQUITA

Phocoena sinus

Unique to the Sea of Cortéz (Gulf of California), this is the smallest and rarest porpoise, often inhabiting lagoons so shallow that its back protrudes above the surface.



BELUGA

Delphinapterus leucas

The beluga has a circumpolar distribution in Arctic and subarctic waters, spending the winter around and under pack ice. Uniquely, it is entirely white as an adult.